

0.0.1 Assemblies

parisāsuttam

1. There are, O bhikkhus, these two assemblies. Which two? The assembly trained in empty talk, not in counter-questioning, and the assembly trained in counter-questioning, not in empty talk.

dvemā bhikkhave parisā. katamā dve: okkācitavinītā¹ parisā no paṭipucchāvinītā, paṭipucchāvinītā parisā no okkācitavinītā.

2. And which, O bhikkhus, is the assembly trained in empty talk, not in counter-questioning? “Here, O bhikkhus, in this assembly, when the discourses spoken by the Tathagata that are deep, deep in meaning, supramundane, connected with voidness, are being expounded, the bhikkhus do not listen. They do not give ear attentively. They do not apply their minds to understand it. They think those dhammas should not be learned and mastered. However, when discourses spoken by poets, elegant in sound, elegant in phrasing, [composed by] outsiders, spoken by disciples, are being expounded, the bhikkhus do listen. They give ear attentively. They apply their minds to understand it. They think those dhammas should be learned and mastered. They, having mastered that dhamma, do not examine and cross-question each

¹ukkācīkavinītā - sīmu, sīl, pts, syā

other [asking]: “How is this? What is the meaning of this?” They do not disclose the undisclosed, do not explain the unexplained, and they do not dispel their doubts in regard to the numerous perplexing dhammas. This, O bhikkhus, is called the assembly trained in empty talk, not in counter-questioning.”

katamā ca bhikkhave okkācitavinītā parisā no paṭipucchāvinītā: idha bhikkhave yassaṃ parisāyaṃ bhikkhū ye te suttantā tathāgatabhāsītā gambhīrā gambhīratthā lokuttarā suññatā² paṭisaññuttā. tesu bhaññamānesu na sussūsanti na sotam odahanti, na aññācittam upaṭṭhapenti, na ca te dhamme uggahetabbam pariyaṇupaiṇitabbam maññanti. ye pana te suttantā kavikatā³ kāveyyā cittakkharā cittabyañjanā bāhirakā sāvakabhāsītā. tesu bhaññamānesu sussūsanti, sotam odahanti, aññācittam upaṭṭhapenti, te ca dhamme uggahetabbam pariyaṇupaiṇitabbam maññanti. te taṃ dhammam pariyaṇupaiṇitvā na ceva aññamaññaṃ paṭipucchanti, paṭivivaranti⁴ idaṃ katham imassa kvatthoti? te avivaṭaṇceva na vivaranti, anuttānikatañca no uttānī karonti. anekavihitesu ca kaṅkhāṭṭhānīyesu dhammesu kaṅkham na paṭivinodenti⁵. ayaṃ vuccati bhikkhave okkācitavinītā parisā no paṭipucchāvinītā.

²suññātaṇṇapaṭisaṃyuttā - syā

³kavitā - machasaṃ

⁴pavivaranti - katthaci

⁵nappaṭivinodenti - machasaṃ, syā

3. And which, O bhikkhus, is the assembly trained in counter-questioning, not in empty talk? “Here, O bhikkhus, in this assembly, when discourses spoken by poets, elegant in sound, elegant in phrasing, [composed by] outsiders, spoken by disciples, are being expounded, the bhikkhus do not listen. They do not give ear attentively. They do not apply their minds to understand it. They think those dhammas should not be learned and mastered. However, when the discourses spoken by the Tathagata that are deep, deep in meaning, supramundane, connected with voidness, are being expounded, the bhikkhus do listen. They give ear attentively. They apply their minds to understand it. They think those dhammas should be learned and mastered. They, having mastered that dhamma, do examine and cross-question each other [asking]: “How is this? What is the meaning of this?” They disclose the undisclosed, explain the unexplained, and they dispel their doubts in regard to the numerous perplexing dhammas. This, O bhikkhus, is called the assembly trained in counter-questioning, not in empty talk.”

katamā ca bhikkhave paṭipucchāvinītā parisā no okkācitavinītā: idha bhikkhave yassaṃ parisāyaṃ bhikkhū ye te suttantā, kavikatā kāveyyā cittakharā cittabyañjanā bāhirakā sāvakabhāsītā, tesu bhaññamānesu na sussūsanti, na sotam odahanti. na aññā cittam upaṭṭhapenti, na ca te dhamme uggahetabbam pariyaṇitabbam maññanti. ye pana te suttantā tathāgatabhāsītā gambhīrā gam-

bhīratthā lokuttarā suññatā paṭisaññuttā, tesu bhañ-
 ñamānesu sussūsanti, sotam odahanti, aññā cit-
 tam upaṭṭhapenti, te ca dhamme uggahetabbam
 pariyaṇupitabbam maññanti. te tam dhammam
 pariyaṇupitvā aññamaññaṃ paṭipucchanti, paṭi-
 vicaranti, idaṃ katham? imassa kvatthoti⁶, te avi-
 vaṭaṇceva vivaranti? anuttānīkataanca uttānīka-
 ronti, anekavihitesu ca kaṅkhāṭhānīyesu dham-
 mesu kaṅkham paṭivinodenti. ayaṃ vuccati bhik-
 khave paṭipucchāvinītā parisā no okkācitavinītā.

4. “Of these two assemblies, O bhikkhus, this is the
 highest, O bhikkhus, namely, the assembly trained in
 counter-questioning, not in empty talk.”

imā kho bhikkhave dve parisā etadaggaṃ bhik-
 khave imāsaṃ dvinnam parisānaṃ yadidaṃ paṭi-
 pucchāvinītā parisā no okkācitavinītāti.

⁶ko atthoti - machasaṃ

